

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI**

TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: SEVEN

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: Citizenship & Heritage Studies

TOPIC: Human Rights & the Universal Declaration

Introduction

- Human rights are the basic entitlements of every human being, regardless of race, sex, religion or nationality. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR), adopted by the UN in 1948, is the world's charter of these rights.

The UDHR and its contents

- Thirty articles covering civil and political rights (life, liberty, fair hearing, freedom of expression, assembly) and economic, social and cultural rights (work, education, health, a decent standard of living). Article 1: 'All human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights.' Key conventions that followed: the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (1966) and on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966).

Human rights in Nigeria

- Chapter IV of the 1999 Constitution guarantees: right to life; dignity of the human person; personal liberty; fair hearing; private and family life; freedom of thought, conscience and religion; freedom of expression and the press; peaceful assembly; freedom of movement; and freedom from discrimination. The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) and the courts enforce them.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define human rights.
2. When was the UDHR adopted and by which body?
3. State four rights in Chapter IV of the Nigerian Constitution.
4. Name the agency that protects human rights in Nigeria.

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: EIGHT

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: Citizenship & Heritage Studies

TOPIC: Rule of Law & Democracy

Introduction

- The rule of law is the principle that every person and authority is subject to the law and that the law is supreme. Democracy is government by the people, through freely elected representatives.

Principles of the rule of law (A.V. Dicey)

- **Supremacy of the law** — no punishment except for a breach of the law.
- **Equality before the law** — all citizens, rich or poor, official or private, are equal before the courts.
- **Fundamental human rights** — individual rights are recognised and enforced by the courts.

Principles of democracy

- Popular sovereignty; periodic free and fair elections; majority rule with respect for minority rights; the rule of law; political tolerance; transparency and accountability; separation of powers; free press; and an independent judiciary.

Obstacles in practice

- Corruption and bribery; delay of justice; poverty and ignorance; immunity clauses; executive lawlessness; ethnic and religious bias; and manipulation of the electoral process.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define the rule of law.
2. State the three principles of the rule of law.
3. List four principles of democracy.
4. Mention two obstacles to the rule of law in Nigeria.

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: NINE

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: Citizenship & Heritage Studies

TOPIC: Pillars of Democracy

Introduction

- The pillars of democracy are the institutions and values that support and sustain democratic government. When the pillars are strong, democracy stands; when they are weak, it collapses.

The three arms as pillars

- **Legislature** — makes laws and checks the executive (National Assembly: Senate and House of Representatives).
- **Executive** — implements laws and runs the government (the President and ministers).
- **Judiciary** — interprets laws, settles disputes and enforces rights (the courts, headed by the Supreme Court).
- Other pillars: a free and independent press, an active civil society, the electoral commission (INEC), political parties, the rule of law, and an informed citizenry.

Values that support democracy

- Tolerance, dialogue, compromise, patriotism, transparency, accountability, respect for the rights of others and the rejection of violence.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Name the three arms of government and their functions.
2. Why is the judiciary called the last hope of the common man?
3. State two other pillars of democracy.
4. What values sustain a democracy?

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TEN

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: Citizenship & Heritage Studies

TOPIC: National Consciousness & Patriotism

Introduction

- National consciousness is the sense of belonging to a nation with a common identity; patriotism is the love for and loyalty to one's country, expressed in deeds.

Elements of national identity

- The flag (green-white-green), the coat of arms, the national anthem and pledge, the currency, festivals, the national dress and language, shared history and heroes, and national institutions.

Ways of showing patriotism

- Respecting national symbols; obeying laws and paying taxes; participating in elections and community service; defending the nation; promoting unity in diversity; rejecting corruption, tribalism and nepotism; doing excellent work; and projecting Nigeria positively abroad.

Obstacles

- Ethnic and religious divisions; corruption; regional imbalance; bad leadership; poverty; fake news and foreign cultural influence. Remedies: good governance, value re-orientation, social justice, education and civic education.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define national consciousness.
2. What does each colour of the flag represent?
3. State three ways of showing patriotism.
4. Mention two obstacles to national unity and how to remove them.

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: ELEVEN

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: Citizenship & Heritage Studies

TOPIC: Youth, Drug Abuse & Social Vices (Prevention)

Introduction

- Social vices are behaviours that harm the individual and society: drug abuse, cultism, examination malpractice, prostitution, armed robbery, hooliganism and cybercrime. Drug abuse is the misuse of drugs without medical need or beyond prescription.

Causes and effects of drug abuse

- Causes: peer pressure, frustration, poverty, curiosity, broken homes, the influence of celebrities, unemployment and the easy availability of drugs. Effects: addiction, health damage (liver, brain, mental illness), poor academic performance, loss of self-control and crime, family problems, imprisonment and death. Drugs commonly abused: alcohol, cannabis (Indian hemp), cocaine, heroin, tramadol, codeine and inhalants.

Prevention strategies

- Education and enlightenment campaigns; counselling; strong family upbringing and parental care; youth empowerment and skill acquisition; recreation and sports; enforcement of drug laws by the NDLEA; positive peer influence; and religious and moral instructions.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define drug abuse.
2. State three causes of drug abuse.
3. List four effects of drug abuse on the society.
4. How can the youth be protected from drug abuse?

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TWELVE

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: Citizenship & Heritage Studies

TOPIC: National Integration & Unity

Introduction

- National integration is the process of welding different ethnic, religious and regional groups into one united nation. Nigeria's diversity (over 250 ethnic groups) makes integration a continuous task.

Agents of integration

- Education (the national curriculum, NYSC); the federal character principle (fair representation in public service); a federal system with the movement of people (inter-marriage, relocation); national sports and festivals; the media; a common currency and language (English); transport and communication; and shared institutions (army, police).

Obstacles

- Ethnicity and tribalism; religious intolerance; corruption and nepotism; regional economic imbalance; the language barrier; the activities of separatist agitators; and fake news that sharpens divisions.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define national integration.
2. State four agents of national integration.
3. Mention three obstacles to unity in Nigeria.
4. How can the NYSC promote national integration?